

Which window?

There are two different windows to choose from in IDLE. The code window can be used to write and save programs, while the shell window runs Python instructions right away.

SEE ALSO

◀ 92–93 Introducing IDLE

◀ 96–97 Ghost game

The code window

So far in this book, the code window has been used to write programs. You enter the program, save it, run it, and the output appears in the shell window.

▽ Running programs

This process is used for running Python programs. Programs always have to be saved before running them.

Enter code

Save

Run module

Output

1 Enter a program in the code window

Enter this code in the code window, save it, and then click on “Run module” in the “Run” menu to run the program.

```
a = 10
b = 4
print(a + b)
print(a - b)
```

Give “a” the value 10

Give “b” the value 4

The “print” command shows the answers to these sums

2 Output in the shell window

When the program runs, its output (the results of the program) is shown in the shell window.

```
>>>
14
6
```

The answers to the sums appear in the shell window

The shell window

Python can also understand commands that are typed in the shell window. They run as soon as they are typed in, and the result is shown straight away.

```
>>> a = 10
>>> b = 4
>>> a + b
14
>>> a - b
6
```

Output appears immediately

The first two commands have no output because they are just assigning values to “a” and “b”

◀ Code and output together

The shell window shows the code and the output together. It’s easier to tell which answer belongs to which sum when the commands are typed in the shell window.



△ Test your ideas

The shell window gives you an immediate response, which makes it ideal for testing instructions and exploring what they can do.